



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF FASHION TECHNOLOGY, BHUBANESWAR

Subject : Apparel Merchandising/ Sourcing and Costing of Apparel
Product

Comparative Sourcing and Costing Analysis of Men's Oversized
Heavyweight Hoodies:

Turkey & Morocco

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Global Garment Industry

The global garment industry is one of the most dynamic and influential sectors within the international manufacturing and trade ecosystem. The industry operates through highly interconnected global supply chains involving fiber production, textile manufacturing, apparel assembly, logistics, branding, retailing, and e-commerce distribution. Over the past few decades, globalization, technological advancement, fast fashion expansion, and changing consumer behaviour have significantly transformed the structure of apparel manufacturing and sourcing practices worldwide. The garment industry contributes substantially to employment generation, export earnings, industrial development, and economic growth, particularly in developing and emerging economies (McKinsey & Company, 2024).

The apparel industry is characterized by labour-intensive manufacturing operations combined with increasingly sophisticated sourcing and supply chain strategies. Major global fashion brands rely on geographically diversified sourcing networks to optimize production costs, lead times, quality standards, and sustainability performance. Countries specializing in textile and apparel manufacturing have developed vertically integrated ecosystems consisting of spinning mills, knitting and weaving units, dyeing and finishing plants, garment factories, trims suppliers, logistics infrastructure, and export-oriented industrial clusters (World Trade Organization [WTO], 2023).

The growth of fast fashion and nearshoring strategies has accelerated the transformation of global apparel manufacturing. Brands increasingly demand shorter lead times, flexible minimum order quantities (MOQs), rapid replenishment systems, sustainable sourcing practices, and digitally integrated production capabilities. Consequently, countries with strategic geographic advantages, advanced manufacturing infrastructure, and strong textile ecosystems have become highly competitive sourcing destinations for global buyers (McKinsey & Company, 2024).

Technological advancements such as automation, digital product development, artificial intelligence (AI), 3D sampling, RFID tracking, and Industry 4.0 manufacturing systems are reshaping the apparel production landscape. At the same time, sustainability concerns regarding carbon emissions, water usage, textile waste, and labour ethics are influencing sourcing decisions and regulatory frameworks within the global fashion industry. As a result, sustainability certifications such as GOTS, OEKO-TEX, GRS, WRAP, and Bluesign have become increasingly important in export-oriented apparel manufacturing (Textile Exchange, 2023).

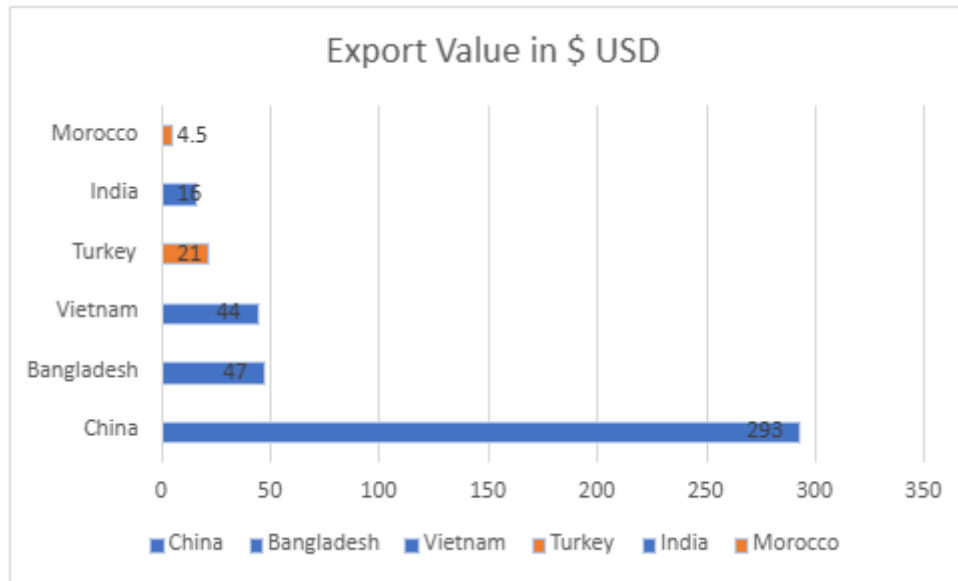


Figure 1 Approximate apparel export values based on WTO, UN Comtrade, national trade bodies, and industry reports (2024–2025).

1.2 Leading Exporters

The global apparel export market is dominated by several major manufacturing countries that specialize in different product categories, sourcing capabilities, and manufacturing models. China continues to remain the world’s largest apparel exporter due to its vertically integrated textile infrastructure, advanced manufacturing technology, massive production capacity, and highly developed supply chain ecosystem. However, rising labour costs and geopolitical shifts have encouraged brands to diversify sourcing into countries such as Bangladesh, Vietnam, Turkey, India, and Morocco (World Bank, 2023).

Bangladesh has emerged as one of the leading exporters of knitwear and basic apparel products due to its cost-competitive labour force, large-scale garment factories, and strong export-oriented industrial base. Vietnam has gained significant market share through free trade agreements, advanced manufacturing capabilities, and strong integration into global supply chains. India remains a major player because of its abundant cotton production, textile diversity, skilled workforce, and vertically integrated textile industry (WTO, 2023).

Turkey occupies a strategically important position in global apparel trade due to its proximity to Europe, strong textile ecosystem, advanced knitwear manufacturing capabilities, and nearshoring advantages. Turkish manufacturers are particularly recognized for premium knitwear, denim, streetwear, and fast-fashion production. The country’s vertically integrated supply chain enables rapid production cycles and shorter lead times compared to many Asian sourcing destinations (International Apparel Federation, 2024).

Morocco has also emerged as an important apparel sourcing hub for European brands due to its geographic proximity to Europe, competitive labour structure, and integration with Euro-Mediterranean trade networks. Moroccan apparel manufacturing is highly focused on fast fashion, nearshoring, and quick-response production systems. European brands increasingly

utilize Moroccan suppliers for replenishment-based sourcing strategies requiring shorter transit times and agile manufacturing capabilities (Oxford Business Group, 2023).

The global apparel export landscape is therefore becoming increasingly diversified as brands balance cost optimization, speed-to-market requirements, sustainability goals, geopolitical risks, and supply chain resilience.

1.3 Major Apparel Importing Regions and Their Sourcing Patterns, Evolving Trade Trends and Strategic Outlook

The European Union (EU), the United States, the United Kingdom, and Japan represent the major apparel importing regions globally. These markets account for a substantial share of global apparel consumption and significantly influence sourcing strategies across the international fashion industry. The sourcing patterns of these importing regions are influenced by factors such as cost competitiveness, lead time efficiency, trade agreements, sustainability compliance, and consumer demand patterns (Statista, 2024).

The European Union is one of the largest apparel importing regions and increasingly emphasizes nearshoring and sustainability-driven sourcing. European brands prioritize suppliers capable of providing shorter lead times, lower carbon footprints, flexible production capacities, and compliance with stringent environmental and social regulations. As a result, countries such as Turkey and Morocco have become strategically important sourcing partners for European retailers and fast-fashion companies. Their geographic proximity allows significantly reduced shipping times compared to Asian sourcing destinations, enabling rapid replenishment and trend-responsive production (European Commission, 2023).

The United States apparel market continues to rely heavily on Asian sourcing countries such as China, Vietnam, Bangladesh, and India due to large-scale manufacturing capabilities and cost efficiency. However, diversification strategies have accelerated due to trade tensions, tariff structures, and supply chain disruptions experienced during the COVID-19 pandemic. American brands are increasingly exploring regional sourcing options, automation technologies, and sustainable sourcing partnerships to improve supply chain resilience and reduce dependency on single-country sourcing models (McKinsey & Company, 2024).

Fast fashion has fundamentally reshaped sourcing patterns by increasing the importance of speed-to-market and agile manufacturing. Retailers such as Zara, H&M, Bershka, Pull&Bear, and Mango utilize multi-country sourcing strategies that combine low-cost Asian production with nearshore suppliers in Turkey and Morocco for rapid replenishment and fashion responsiveness. This hybrid sourcing model enables brands to balance cost efficiency with flexibility and shorter production cycles (Business of Fashion, 2024).

Sustainability has become one of the most significant evolving trends in global apparel trade. Regulatory developments such as the European Union's Digital Product Passport (DPP), Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD), and Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) frameworks are compelling brands and manufacturers to increase

transparency, traceability, and environmental accountability throughout the supply chain. Consequently, apparel manufacturers capable of meeting ESG requirements and sustainability certifications are expected to gain competitive advantages in future global sourcing networks (Textile Exchange, 2023).

Another major trend influencing the strategic outlook of the apparel industry is digital transformation. Technologies such as AI-driven forecasting, digital sampling, virtual product development, automated cutting systems, RFID integration, and smart manufacturing are becoming increasingly important in modern apparel production systems. These innovations are enabling manufacturers to improve operational efficiency, reduce waste, accelerate product development, and optimize inventory management (McKinsey & Company, 2024).

Overall, the future strategic outlook of global apparel sourcing is expected to focus on sustainability, speed, flexibility, regional diversification, digitalization, and resilient supply chain development.

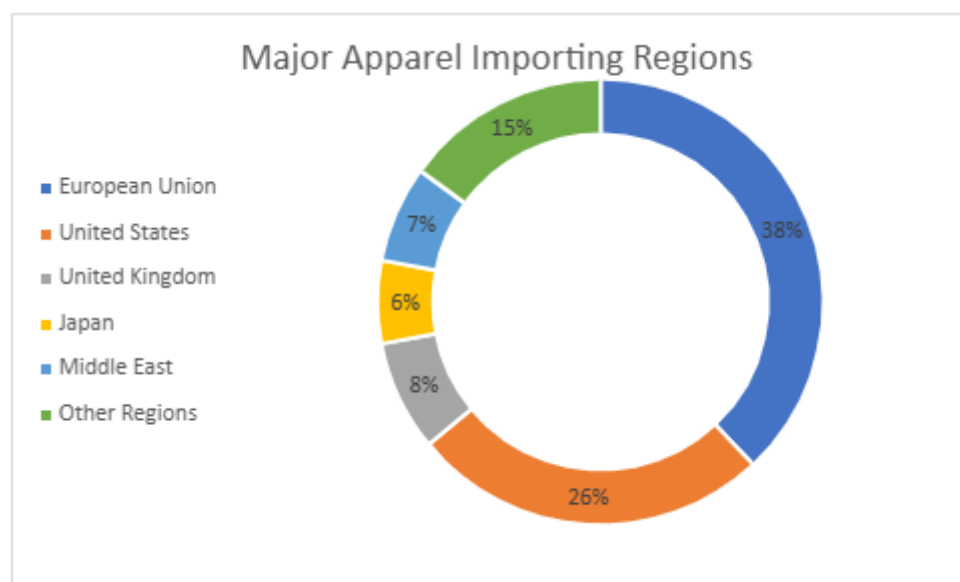


Figure 2 Approximate global apparel import share distribution based on OECD sourcing trends, WTO trade reports, McKinsey fashion market analysis, and international apparel consumption patterns (2024–2025).

1.4 Product Category Selected: Men's Hoodie

The product category selected for this study is the men's hoodie, which has become one of the most influential and commercially significant garments within the global apparel and streetwear market. Originally developed as functional sportswear and workwear, hoodies have evolved into essential lifestyle products associated with casualwear, athleisure, luxury streetwear, and contemporary fashion culture (FashionUnited, 2024).

The increasing popularity of hoodies can be attributed to changing consumer lifestyles, the rise of athleisure, growing streetwear influence, and the demand for comfortable multifunctional apparel. Hoodies are widely consumed across multiple market segments including fast fashion,

premium casualwear, sportswear, luxury fashion, and sustainable apparel. The garment's versatility, comfort, functionality, and branding potential make it a strategically important product category for global apparel brands (Business of Fashion, 2024).

Men's hoodies are manufactured using a wide range of knit fabrics such as brushed fleece, French Terry, cotton-polyester fleece, loop knit, interlock knit, and heavyweight jersey fabrics. Fabric selection significantly influences garment aesthetics, comfort, thermal insulation, drape, durability, and overall product positioning. Premium hoodies often utilize heavyweight brushed fleece fabrics with specialized finishing processes such as enzyme washing, silicone washing, garment dyeing, and anti-pilling treatments to achieve superior hand feel and visual appeal (Textile World, 2023).

The hoodie category also incorporates a diverse trims and accessories ecosystem including drawcords, aglets, eyelets, rib cuffs, zippers, labels, silicone badges, embroidery patches, and sustainable packaging systems. Additionally, modern hoodie manufacturing heavily relies on advanced embellishment techniques such as puff printing, DTG printing, embroidery, chenille applications, garment dyeing, acid washing, and vintage finishing effects to enhance product differentiation and brand identity.

From a sourcing and manufacturing perspective, hoodies require specialized knitwear production capabilities, advanced finishing infrastructure, and flexible manufacturing systems capable of handling both basic and fashion-intensive production requirements. Countries such as Turkey and Morocco are increasingly recognized as competitive sourcing destinations for hoodie manufacturing due to their knitwear ecosystems, strategic location advantages, and ability to support fast-fashion and nearshoring business models.

2. GARMENT INDUSTRY IN TURKEY AND MOROCCO

2.1 Turkey

Turkey is one of the world's most strategically positioned textile and apparel manufacturing countries, functioning as a major bridge between Europe, Asia, and the Middle East. The Turkish textile and garment industry has evolved into a highly integrated manufacturing ecosystem supported by advanced spinning, knitting, weaving, dyeing, finishing, garmenting, logistics, and export infrastructure. The country has established itself as a premium sourcing destination for fast fashion, knitwear, denim, athleisure, and streetwear manufacturing due to its strong vertical integration and geographic proximity to European markets (International Trade Administration, 2023).

The Turkish apparel industry contributes significantly to the country's economy through exports, employment generation, industrial development, and foreign exchange earnings. According to the Turkish Exporters Assembly, the textile and apparel sector accounts for approximately 10% of Turkey's total exports and employs more than one million workers directly and indirectly across the textile value chain (Turkish Exporters Assembly, 2024). Turkey is particularly known for high-quality cotton production, advanced knitwear

capabilities, rapid sampling systems, and flexible manufacturing structures suitable for fast-fashion production cycles.

One of the major competitive advantages of Turkey lies in its vertically integrated manufacturing model. Turkish manufacturers can control the entire supply chain from yarn spinning to finished garment exports within a single production ecosystem. This significantly reduces lead times, enhances quality control, and improves sourcing flexibility for international brands. Turkish suppliers are therefore highly preferred by European fashion retailers requiring rapid replenishment, shorter production cycles, and low minimum order quantities (MOQs) (McKinsey & Company, 2024).

Turkey’s major garment manufacturing hubs include Istanbul, Bursa, Izmir, Denizli, Gaziantep, and Kahramanmaraş. Istanbul functions as the primary sourcing and export centre, housing numerous apparel exporters, fashion brands, trims suppliers, and sourcing offices. Bursa and Denizli are known for textile manufacturing, circular knitting, towel production, and knitwear processing. Kahramanmaraş is recognized as one of Turkey’s largest knit fabric and yarn production centers, particularly for fleece and French Terry manufacturing used in hoodies and sweatshirts (Oxford Business Group, 2023).

Turkish manufacturers are highly specialized in products such as:

- Knitwear
- Hoodies and sweatshirts
- Denim garments
- Sportswear
- Streetwear
- Athleisure apparel
- Premium casualwear
- Luxury knitwear

The country’s proximity to Europe enables shipping lead times of approximately 5–10 days compared to 25–40 days from many Asian sourcing countries. This logistical advantage has significantly strengthened Turkey’s position as a nearshoring destination for brands such as Zara, H&M, Mango, Bershka, Pull&Bear, COS, ASOS, and Hugo Boss (Business of Fashion, 2024).

Turkey is also increasingly investing in sustainability and digital manufacturing systems. Many Turkish factories have adopted renewable energy systems, wastewater treatment facilities, circular textile initiatives, and certifications such as GOTS, OEKO-TEX, GRS, WRAP, Sedex, and BSCI to comply with European sustainability regulations and buyer expectations (Textile Exchange, 2023).

Table 2.1 Turkey Apparel Industry Overview

Factor	Details
Major Manufacturing Cities	Istanbul, Bursa, Izmir, Denizli, Gaziantep, Kahramanmaraş

Key Product Categories	Knitwear, Hoodies, Denim, Sportswear, Streetwear
Major Export Markets	Germany, UK, Spain, France, Netherlands
Industry Contribution to Exports	~10% of Turkey's total exports
Estimated Industry Employment	1+ million workers
Average EU Transit Time	5–10 days
Main Competitive Advantage	Nearshoring + Vertical Integration
Sustainability Certifications	GOTS, OEKO-TEX, GRS, WRAP, Sedex

2.2 Morocco

Morocco has emerged as one of the most important apparel sourcing hubs in the Euro-Mediterranean region due to its strategic geographic location, trade agreements with the European Union and the United States, and strong integration into fast-fashion supply chains. The Moroccan apparel industry operates as a highly export-oriented sector focused primarily on European markets, particularly Spain, France, Portugal, and the United Kingdom (Oxford Business Group, 2023).

The country's garment manufacturing ecosystem has expanded significantly over the past two decades through foreign investment, industrial modernization, and the development of specialized textile and export-processing zones. Morocco's apparel industry employs approximately 190,000–200,000 workers and contributes substantially to national industrial exports and manufacturing GDP (Moroccan Investment and Export Development Agency, 2024).

Unlike Turkey, Morocco's textile ecosystem is less vertically integrated and relies more heavily on imported fabrics and trims from countries such as Turkey, China, Spain, Portugal, and Italy. However, Morocco's major strength lies in its ability to support rapid replenishment, low lead-time manufacturing, and flexible fast-fashion production systems for European brands. This has made Morocco a critical sourcing partner for brands such as Zara, Mango, Pull&Bear, Bershka, Decathlon, and Inditex Group suppliers (European Commission, 2023).

Major apparel manufacturing hubs in Morocco include Casablanca, Tangier, Rabat, Fez, and Kenitra. Casablanca serves as the primary textile and garment manufacturing center, while Tangier has developed into a strategic export and logistics hub due to the Tangier Med Port and associated industrial free zones. Tangier's advanced logistics infrastructure significantly enhances Morocco's connectivity with European markets and supports quick-response manufacturing strategies (Moroccan Investment and Export Development Agency, 2024).

Morocco is particularly recognized for:

- Fast-fashion garment production
- Knitwear manufacturing
- Casualwear
- Denim
- Sportswear

- Streetwear
- European nearshoring production

The country's geographic proximity allows shipping lead times to Europe within approximately 2–7 days depending on the destination market. This speed advantage is highly valuable for fast-fashion retailers requiring rapid inventory replenishment and short production cycles (Business of Fashion, 2024).

Morocco is also increasing investments in sustainability and renewable energy within the textile sector. The adoption of solar energy, wastewater recycling systems, and ESG compliance initiatives is expanding as European regulations become stricter regarding sustainable sourcing and traceability (Textile Exchange, 2023).

Table 2.2 Morocco Apparel Industry Overview

Factor	Details
Major Manufacturing Cities	Casablanca, Tangier, Rabat, Fez, Kenitra
Key Product Categories	Fast Fashion, Knitwear, Hoodies, Denim, Sportswear
Major Export Markets	Spain, France, UK, Portugal, Germany
Estimated Industry Employment	190,000–200,000 workers
Average EU Transit Time	2–7 days
Main Competitive Advantage	Fast Fashion Nearshoring
Main Fabric Sourcing Countries	Turkey, China, Portugal, Spain
Sustainability Focus	Renewable Energy + ESG Compliance

2.3 Hoodie Manufacturing and Exports in Turkey and Morocco

The global growth of athleisure, casualwear, and streetwear has significantly increased demand for hoodies and sweatshirt-based apparel products. Hoodies have evolved from basic sportswear garments into highly commercialized fashion products used across fast fashion, luxury streetwear, premium casualwear, and sustainable apparel segments. Turkey and Morocco have emerged as increasingly important sourcing destinations for hoodie manufacturing due to their knitwear ecosystems, fast-fashion compatibility, and strategic proximity to European markets.

The hoodie manufacturing ecosystem requires advanced knit fabric infrastructure, specialized fleece processing capabilities, skilled garment assembly operations, and strong embellishment systems such as printing, embroidery, washing, and garment dyeing. Both Turkey and Morocco possess strong manufacturing capabilities in these areas, although Turkey has a more vertically integrated and technically advanced production ecosystem compared to Morocco.

The rise of oversized hoodies, heavyweight fleece garments, vintage wash effects, and premium streetwear products has further increased demand for countries capable of delivering high-quality knitwear with shorter lead times. European brands increasingly utilize Turkey and Morocco for replenishment-based sourcing models and trend-responsive manufacturing systems.

Table 2.3 Comparative Hoodie Manufacturing Ecosystem

Factor	Turkey	Morocco
Manufacturing Model	Vertically Integrated	Fast Fashion Nearshoring
Fabric Production Capability	High	Moderate
Knitwear Ecosystem	Advanced	Developing
Hoodie Production Capacity	Very High	High
Main Export Region	Europe	Europe
Average EU Transit Time	5–10 days	2–7 days
Typical MOQ	Medium	Low to Medium
Major Product Strength	Premium Hoodies & Knitwear	Fast Fashion Hoodies
Sustainability Adoption	Advanced	Growing
Major Buyers	Zara, H&M, Mango, COS	Zara, Bershka, Pull&Bear

2.3.1 Turkey Hoodie Manufacturing and Exports

Turkey is considered one of Europe’s most important sourcing destinations for premium hoodies, sweatshirts, and knitwear garments. The country’s advanced circular knitting ecosystem, fleece manufacturing infrastructure, and vertically integrated textile supply chain provide strong competitive advantages for hoodie manufacturing. Turkish factories specialize in premium heavyweight fleece hoodies, French Terry garments, oversized streetwear hoodies, sportswear hoodies, and sustainable knitwear products (Textile World, 2023).

Approximately 35–40% of Turkey’s knitwear exports consist of sweatshirts, hoodies, T-shirts, and casual knit garments, demonstrating the significant role of knitwear products within the country’s apparel export structure (Turkish Statistical Institute, 2024). Turkish hoodie production is concentrated in manufacturing hubs such as Istanbul, Kahramanmaraş, Bursa, and Izmir, where numerous circular knitting mills, dyeing facilities, garment factories, and trims suppliers operate within integrated industrial clusters.

Turkish hoodie manufacturers are highly recognized for:

- Heavyweight fleece manufacturing
- French Terry processing
- Premium garment dyeing
- Vintage wash techniques
- Puff printing
- High-density printing
- Streetwear embellishment
- Luxury casualwear production

The country’s strong local textile ecosystem enables manufacturers to source:

- Cotton yarns
- Fleece fabrics

- Rib fabrics
- Labels
- Drawcords
- Zippers
- Packaging materials

within domestic supply chains, significantly reducing production lead times and increasing sourcing flexibility.

Major Turkish hoodie manufacturers and exporters include:

- Taha Group
- Sanko Textile
- Aster Textile
- Bilsar Textile
- Sun Textile
- Yeşim Textile
- Akcakaya Textile
- Sareteks

These companies export hoodies and knitwear products to leading global brands including Zara, Mango, H&M, Nike, Adidas, Hugo Boss, ASOS, and COS (Fibre2Fashion, 2024).

Table 2.4 Turkey Hoodie Manufacturing Ecosystem

Factor	Details
Estimated Knitwear Export Share	35–40%
Main Hoodie Manufacturing Cities	Istanbul, Bursa, Kahramanmaraş, Izmir
Major Hoodie Types	Oversized, Heavyweight, Zip-Up, Luxury Hoodies
Key Fabric Types	French Terry, Brushed Fleece, Cotton-Poly Fleece
Main Export Markets	Germany, Spain, UK, France
Major Buyers	Zara, H&M, Mango, Nike, Adidas
Competitive Strength	Premium Knitwear + Fast Replenishment

2.3.2 Morocco Hoodie Manufacturing and Exports

Morocco’s hoodie manufacturing industry is strongly aligned with fast-fashion and nearshoring production models. The country’s strategic location near Europe and its integration into Euro-Mediterranean trade networks have enabled Moroccan garment factories to become important suppliers for European fast-fashion retailers requiring shorter lead times and flexible production systems.

Although Morocco imports a substantial portion of its knit fabrics from Turkey, Portugal, Spain, and China, the country has developed strong competencies in garment assembly, hoodie

construction, printing, embroidery, and fast-fashion manufacturing workflows. Moroccan factories specialize primarily in:

- Lightweight hoodies
- Fast-fashion sweatshirts
- Basic fleece hoodies
- Sportswear hoodies
- Casual knitwear

The major hoodie manufacturing hubs in Morocco include Casablanca, Tangier, and Rabat, where export-oriented garment factories operate in close proximity to logistics ports and industrial free zones. The Tangier Med logistics hub significantly strengthens Morocco’s apparel export efficiency by enabling rapid shipping access to European markets.

Approximately 25–30% of Morocco’s knitwear apparel exports consist of sweatshirts, hoodies, T-shirts, and casual knit garments, reflecting the growing importance of knitwear products within the country’s export structure (Moroccan Ministry of Industry and Trade, 2024).

Major Moroccan hoodie manufacturers and exporters include:

- New Wash
- Inter Tricot
- Soft Group Morocco
- Moda In
- Casablanca Apparel
- Richbond Group
- Vita Couture

These companies primarily supply European fast-fashion brands including Zara, Pull&Bear, Bershka, Mango, and Decathlon.

Table 2.5 Morocco Hoodie Manufacturing Ecosystem

Factor	Details
Estimated Knitwear Export Share	25–30%
Main Hoodie Manufacturing Cities	Casablanca, Tangier, Rabat
Major Hoodie Types	Fast Fashion, Casualwear, Sportswear Hoodies
Main Fabric Sources	Turkey, Portugal, China
Main Export Markets	Spain, France, UK
Major Buyers	Zara, Bershka, Mango, Decathlon
Competitive Strength	Fast Fashion Nearshoring

3. MEN’S HOODIE

Men’s hoodies have evolved from functional sportswear garments into one of the most commercially important categories within contemporary apparel manufacturing. The product category is now positioned across multiple fashion segments including fast fashion, luxury streetwear, athleisure, sportswear, premium casualwear, and sustainable fashion. Hoodies are

characterized by their comfort, thermal insulation, versatility, and strong branding potential, making them highly suitable for modern consumer lifestyles and fashion trends (Business of Fashion, 2024).

The manufacturing of hoodies requires specialized knit fabrics, technically engineered trims, and advanced garment finishing processes to achieve desired aesthetic, comfort, and performance characteristics. Fabric selection plays a crucial role in determining hoodie quality, silhouette, drape, durability, breathability, thermal performance, and overall product positioning. Commonly used fabrics in hoodie manufacturing include French Terry, brushed fleece, cotton-polyester fleece, heavyweight fleece, loop knit, interlock knit, and jersey knit fabrics (Textile World, 2023).

The global demand for oversized hoodies, heavyweight streetwear, vintage-washed garments, and premium fleece apparel has significantly increased the importance of technical knitwear manufacturing ecosystems. Manufacturers in Turkey and Morocco increasingly specialize in producing fashion-oriented hoodies using advanced finishing techniques such as garment dyeing, enzyme washing, silicone washing, anti-pilling treatments, puff printing, DTG printing, and embroidery applications.

3.1 Fabric Characteristics

Fabric characteristics significantly influence the technical and commercial performance of hoodies. Parameters such as GSM, fiber composition, yarn count, knit construction, hand feel, drape, breathability, durability, and finishing treatments determine the garment’s comfort, appearance, thermal insulation, and market positioning.

Hoodie fabrics are primarily knitted fabrics due to their flexibility, softness, elasticity, and thermal comfort. The most commonly used constructions include fleece knit, French Terry knit, interlock knit, rib knit, and jersey knit structures. These fabrics undergo various post-knitting finishing treatments such as brushing, compacting, enzyme washing, silicone softening, anti-pilling finishing, and garment dyeing to improve hand feel, dimensional stability, and aesthetic appeal (Textile Exchange, 2023).

3.1.1 Fabric Types

A. French Terry Fabric

French Terry is one of the most widely used fabrics for premium hoodies, athleisure garments, and lightweight sweatshirts. The fabric is characterized by smooth outer surfaces and looped inner structures that provide moderate thermal insulation and high moisture absorption.

Table 3.1 French Terry Fabric Characteristics

Parameter	Details
Fiber Content	100% Cotton / Cotton-Poly Blend

Fabric Type	Knitted Fabric
Surface Design	Smooth Face with Looped Back
Yarn Count	20s–40s
Construction	Weft Knit
EPI × PPI Equivalent	Approx. 28 × 22 loops/cm
GSM Range	280–420 GSM
Weave/Knit Structure	French Terry Loop Knit
Feel/Hand	Soft, Smooth, Moisture Absorbent
Drape	Moderate
Air Permeability	Medium to High
Wrinkle Resistance	Moderate
Color Fastness	Good
Finishes Applied	Enzyme Wash, Silicone Wash, Compacting
Post-Knitting Treatments	Brushing, Bio-Wash
Texture	Soft with Looped Interior
Breathability	High
Shrinkage	Moderate if untreated
Durability	Good
Care Instructions	Machine Wash Cold, Avoid High Heat

Common Prints & Embellishments Used on French Terry

Print Type	Suitability
Screen Printing	Excellent
Puff Printing	Very Good
DTG Printing	Excellent
Embroidery	Excellent
Silicone Print	Good
High-Density Print	Good
Reflective Print	Good

[INSERT FABRIC CLOSE-UP IMAGE: French Terry Knit Structure]

B. Brushed Fleece Fabric

Brushed fleece is the most commonly used fabric in heavyweight hoodies and winter streetwear garments. The inner side of the fabric undergoes brushing processes to create soft raised fibers that improve insulation and comfort.

Table 3.2 Brushed Fleece Fabric Characteristics

Parameter	Details
Fiber Content	Cotton / Cotton-Polyester Blend
Fabric Type	Knitted Fleece
Surface Design	Smooth Face with Brushed Back
Yarn Count	16s–30s
Construction	3-End Fleece Knit

EPI × PPI Equivalent	Approx. 24 × 18 loops/cm
GSM Range	320–500 GSM
Weave/Knit Structure	Fleece Knit
Feel/Hand	Thick, Soft, Warm
Drape	Heavy
Air Permeability	Moderate
Wrinkle Resistance	Good
Color Fastness	Very Good
Finishes Applied	Brushing, Compacting, Anti-Pilling
Post-Knitting Treatments	Silicone Wash, Enzyme Wash
Texture	Raised Fleece Interior
Breathability	Moderate
Shrinkage	Controlled after Compacting
Durability	High
Care Instructions	Cold Wash, Low Tumble Dry

Common Prints & Embellishments Used on Brushed Fleece

Print Type	Suitability
Puff Printing	Excellent
Screen Printing	Excellent
Embroidery	Excellent
Chenille Embroidery	Very Good
DTF Printing	Good
High-Density Print	Excellent
Silicone Branding	Excellent

[INSERT FABRIC CLOSE-UP IMAGE: Brushed Fleece Structure]

C. Cotton-Polyester Fleece Fabric

Cotton-polyester fleece fabrics are extensively used in fast-fashion hoodies due to their cost efficiency, durability, and wrinkle resistance.

Table 3.3 Cotton-Polyester Fleece Characteristics

Parameter	Details
Fiber Content	60% Cotton / 40% Polyester
Fabric Type	Knitted Blend Fleece
Surface Design	Smooth Outer Face
Yarn Count	20s–32s
Construction	Fleece Knit
EPI × PPI Equivalent	Approx. 26 × 20 loops/cm
GSM Range	280–450 GSM
Weave/Knit Structure	2-End or 3-End Fleece
Feel/Hand	Soft with Synthetic Stability
Drape	Moderate

Air Permeability	Medium
Wrinkle Resistance	High
Color Fastness	Very Good
Finishes Applied	Anti-Pilling, Silicone Finish
Post-Knitting Treatments	Heat Setting
Texture	Smooth & Slightly Bulky
Breathability	Moderate
Shrinkage	Low
Durability	High
Care Instructions	Machine Wash, Low Heat

Common Prints & Embellishments Used on Cotton-Poly Fleece

Print Type	Suitability
Screen Printing	Excellent
Puff Print	Very Good
DTF Printing	Excellent
Heat Transfer	Excellent
Embroidery	Good
Reflective Print	Excellent

D. Heavyweight Fleece Fabric

Heavyweight fleece fabrics are primarily used in luxury streetwear and premium oversized hoodies due to their superior thickness, structure, and premium hand feel.

Table 3.4 Heavyweight Fleece Fabric Characteristics

Parameter	Details
Fiber Content	100% Cotton / Organic Cotton
Fabric Type	Heavy Knit Fleece
Surface Design	Dense Smooth Face
Yarn Count	10s–20s
Construction	Heavy 3-End Fleece
EPI × PPI Equivalent	Approx. 20 × 16 loops/cm
GSM Range	400–600 GSM
Weave/Knit Structure	Dense Fleece Knit
Feel/Hand	Heavy, Premium, Structured
Drape	Structured Heavy Drape
Air Permeability	Moderate
Wrinkle Resistance	High
Color Fastness	Excellent
Finishes Applied	Compacting, Silicone Softening
Post-Knitting Treatments	Garment Dye, Vintage Wash
Texture	Dense & Luxurious
Breathability	Moderate
Shrinkage	Controlled

Durability	Very High
Care Instructions	Gentle Wash Recommended

Common Prints & Embellishments Used on Heavyweight Fleece

Print Type	Suitability
Puff Printing	Excellent
High-Density Print	Excellent
Embroidery	Excellent
Chenille	Excellent
Silicone Branding	Excellent
DTG Printing	Good

E. Interlock Knit Fabric

Interlock knit fabrics are commonly used in premium athleisure hoodies and performance garments due to their smooth surface, elasticity, and dimensional stability.

Table 3.5 Interlock Knit Fabric Characteristics

Parameter	Details
Fiber Content	Cotton / Polyester / Spandex Blend
Fabric Type	Double Knit
Surface Design	Smooth Both Sides
Yarn Count	24s–40s
Construction	Interlock Knit
EPI × PPI Equivalent	Approx. 30 × 26 loops/cm
GSM Range	250–380 GSM
Weave/Knit Structure	Double Jersey
Feel/Hand	Smooth & Stretchable
Drape	Excellent
Air Permeability	Medium
Wrinkle Resistance	Good
Color Fastness	Excellent
Finishes Applied	Moisture-Wicking Finish
Post-Knitting Treatments	Heat Setting
Texture	Fine Smooth Texture
Breathability	High
Shrinkage	Low
Durability	High
Care Instructions	Machine Wash Cold

Common Prints & Embellishments Used on Interlock Knit

Print Type	Suitability
Heat Transfer	Excellent
Sublimation	Excellent
Silicone Print	Very Good

Reflective Print	Excellent
Embroidery	Good

Comparative Fabric Analysis

Table 3.6 Comparative Hoodie Fabric Analysis

Fabric Type	GSM	Warmth	Breathability	Drape	Durability	Premium Positioning
French Terry	280–420	Moderate	High	Medium	Good	Medium
Brushed Fleece	320–500	High	Medium	Heavy	High	High
Cotton-Poly Fleece	280–450	Moderate	Medium	Medium	High	Medium
Heavyweight Fleece	400–600	Very High	Medium	Structured	Very High	Premium
Interlock Knit	250–380	Medium	High	Excellent	High	Premium Athleisure

3.2 Selected Commercial Hoodie Style for Comparative Costing Analysis

3.2.1 Style Overview

The selected garment style for this comparative sourcing and costing analysis is the **Men's Oversized Pullover Heavyweight Streetwear Hoodie** manufactured using **80% Cotton / 20% Polyester Brushed Fleece fabric** with an average fabric weight of **350–360 GSM**.

This style represents one of the most commercially dominant knitwear products in the global streetwear and casualwear market. The hoodie features an oversized silhouette with dropped shoulders, a double-layer hood, ribbed cuffs and waistband, kangaroo pocket construction, puff print graphic application, and silicone-enzyme garment washing.

The garment is positioned within the **premium casualwear and streetwear segment**, targeting Gen Z and millennial consumers seeking oversized comfort-based fashion aesthetics. The product is widely exported to major European fashion markets including Germany, Spain, France, the Netherlands, Italy, and the United Kingdom.

The selected hoodie style is extensively manufactured in both Turkey and Morocco due to its strong compatibility with:

- fast-fashion replenishment systems,
- premium knitwear manufacturing,
- European nearshoring supply chains,
- and high-volume export production.

Turkey primarily manufactures heavyweight premium hoodies for luxury and mid-premium streetwear brands, while Morocco focuses on agile replenishment production for European fast-fashion retailers.

3.2.2 Product Selection Justification

The Men's Oversized Pullover Heavyweight Hoodie was selected for this study based on its strong commercial relevance, sourcing suitability, manufacturing practicality, and export demand within the global apparel industry.

Reasons for Product Selection

1. High Commercial Demand

Oversized hoodies currently represent one of the highest-selling knitwear categories in global streetwear and athleisure markets. Consumer preference has shifted toward relaxed silhouettes, comfort dressing, and oversized fits, making this style commercially dominant among Gen Z consumers.

2. Strong Manufacturing Presence in Turkey and Morocco

Both Turkey and Morocco possess highly developed knitwear and casualwear export ecosystems. Turkey specializes in vertically integrated heavyweight fleece production, while Morocco specializes in fast-fashion nearshore manufacturing for European brands.

This makes the hoodie ideal for comparative sourcing analysis between:

- vertically integrated manufacturing systems (Turkey),
- and import-dependent nearshore manufacturing systems (Morocco).

3. Suitable for FOB Costing Analysis

The hoodie contains multiple technical and commercial costing components such as:

- heavyweight fleece fabric,
- rib fabric,
- puff printing,
- washing,
- trims,
- packaging,
- and high sewing SAM values.

This allows detailed analysis of:

- direct material costs,
- direct labor costs,
- factory overheads,
- printing costs,
- washing costs,

- and shipment costs.

4. Export-Oriented Product Category

Heavyweight streetwear hoodies are extensively exported to the European Union under FOB sourcing arrangements. The product is suitable for studying:

- sourcing ecosystems,
- trade agreements,
- nearshoring strategies,
- and lead-time optimization.

5. Compatibility with Premium and Fast-Fashion Markets

The selected hoodie style can simultaneously serve:

- premium streetwear brands,
- fast-fashion retailers,
- athleisure brands,
- and luxury casualwear segments.

This commercial flexibility increases its global manufacturing relevance.

3.2.3 Technical Specification Overview

Parameter	Specification
Product Category	Men's Streetwear Hoodie
Garment Type	Pullover Hoodie
Fit Type	Oversized Fit
Silhouette	Boxy Streetwear Silhouette
Fabric Type	3-Thread Brushed Fleece
Fiber Composition	80% Cotton / 20% Polyester
Fabric Weight	350–360 GSM
Fabric Width	180 cm Tubular Width
Surface Finish	Brushed Inner Fleece
Hood Type	Double-Layer Structured Hood
Pocket Type	Kangaroo Pocket
Sleeve Type	Full Sleeve
Shoulder Type	Drop Shoulder
Rib Construction	2×2 Rib Knit
Rib Composition	95% Cotton / 5% Elastane
Printing Technique	Puff Print Screen Printing
Washing Finish	Silicone + Enzyme Wash
Stitch Type	Overlock + Coverstitch + Flatlock
Market Positioning	Premium Streetwear / Fast Fashion
Target Export Markets	Germany, Spain, France, UK, Netherlands
Production System	FOB Export Manufacturing

3.2.4 Commercial Relevance in Turkey and Morocco

Turkey

Turkey is one of the world's leading knitwear and heavyweight fleece manufacturing hubs. The country possesses a highly integrated textile ecosystem consisting of:

- cotton cultivation,
- yarn spinning,
- circular knitting,
- dyeing,
- finishing,
- printing,
- and garment assembly.

Heavyweight oversized hoodies are commercially significant in Turkey because they align with:

- premium European streetwear sourcing,
- sustainable manufacturing initiatives,
- advanced fabric finishing capabilities,
- and vertically integrated supply chains.

Turkish manufacturers specialize in:

- heavyweight fleece production,
- puff printing,
- garment dyeing,
- silicone washing,
- and sustainable knitwear manufacturing.

The country is highly competitive in supplying premium hoodies to:

- luxury casualwear brands,
- independent European labels,
- and premium athleisure companies.

Morocco

Morocco has emerged as a strategic nearshoring apparel hub for Europe due to its:

- low transit times,
- competitive labor costs,
- and proximity to Spain and France.

Moroccan factories primarily focus on:

- fast-fashion hoodie production,
- replenishment manufacturing,
- and agile short-lead export systems.

Oversized hoodies are increasingly manufactured in Morocco because:

- European demand for streetwear has grown rapidly,
- brands require quick replenishment cycles,
- and Moroccan factories can deliver products within very short timelines.

Unlike Turkey, Morocco imports a large portion of its heavyweight fleece fabric from:

- Turkey,
- Portugal,
- and Spain.

However, Morocco maintains competitiveness through:

- lower CMT labor costs,
- efficient logistics systems,
- and fast access to European markets.

3.2.5 Fabric Selection Justification

The selected fabric for this hoodie is **80% Cotton / 20% Polyester 3-Thread Brushed Fleece (350–360 GSM)**.

This fabric was selected due to its superior commercial, technical, and manufacturing performance.

Reasons for Fabric Selection

1. Structural Shape Retention

Heavyweight fleece provides the rigidity required to maintain oversized silhouettes and boxy streetwear shapes. The polyester content improves dimensional stability and reduces garment sagging.

2. Comfort and Thermal Insulation

The brushed fleece backing creates a soft insulating layer that improves warmth and wearer comfort, making it ideal for premium winter casualwear.

3. Commercial Availability

This fabric is widely available in both Turkey and Morocco sourcing systems, making it commercially realistic for export-oriented production.

4. Printing Compatibility

The combed cotton face provides excellent compatibility with:

- puff printing,
- screen printing,
- discharge printing,
- and embroidery applications.

5. Shrinkage and Durability Control

The polyester binding yarn improves:

- dimensional stability,
- wrinkle resistance,
- tensile strength,
- and wash durability.

This helps maintain shrinkage below industrial tolerance limits.

6. Cost Efficiency

Compared to 100% cotton heavyweight fleece, the cotton-poly blend:

- reduces production costs,
- improves wash performance,
- and increases fabric life cycle durability.

3.2.6 Trim and Embellishment Selection

The selected hoodie utilizes commercially standardized trims and embellishments commonly used in premium streetwear manufacturing.

Drawcord

Flat braided cotton drawcords were selected due to:

- premium appearance,
- durability,
- and compatibility with oversized hood aesthetics.

Metal Eyelets

Solid brass eyelets improve:

- hood reinforcement,
- visual premium appeal,
- and long-term durability.

Metal Aglets

Compressed metal aglets prevent drawcord fraying and enhance product aesthetics.

Rib Fabric

2×2 rib knit cuffs and waistbands improve:

- stretch recovery,
- fit retention,
- and garment durability.

Puff Print

Puff printing was selected because it is one of the most commercially dominant decoration techniques in contemporary streetwear. It creates:

- tactile 3D graphics,
- premium visual texture,
- and strong brand identity.

Silicone-Enzyme Wash

The garment wash improves:

- softness,
- colour richness,
- anti-pilling performance,
- and overall premium hand-feel.

Sustainable Packaging

GRS-certified recycled polybags and corrugated cartons were selected to align with:

- global sustainability standards,
- export packaging compliance,
- and brand sustainability initiatives.

3.2.7 Target Market

The selected hoodie style targets the global premium casualwear and streetwear market.

Primary Consumer Segments

- Gen Z consumers
- Streetwear consumers
- Athleisure consumers
- Premium casualwear buyers
- Fast-fashion consumers

Major Export Markets

- Germany
- Spain
- France
- Netherlands
- United Kingdom
- Italy

Target Retail Segments

- Premium streetwear brands
- Fast-fashion retailers

- Luxury casualwear labels
- Online DTC fashion brands
- Athleisure companies

Market Trend Relevance

The oversized heavyweight hoodie aligns with major global fashion trends including:

- comfort-driven dressing,
- oversized silhouettes,
- gender-neutral fashion,
- premium casualwear,
- and athleisure integration.

The style continues to maintain strong commercial demand due to its versatility, comfort, and compatibility with modern streetwear aesthetics.

3.2.8 Commercial Product Visualization & Technical Flat Analysis

Front view	Back view
	

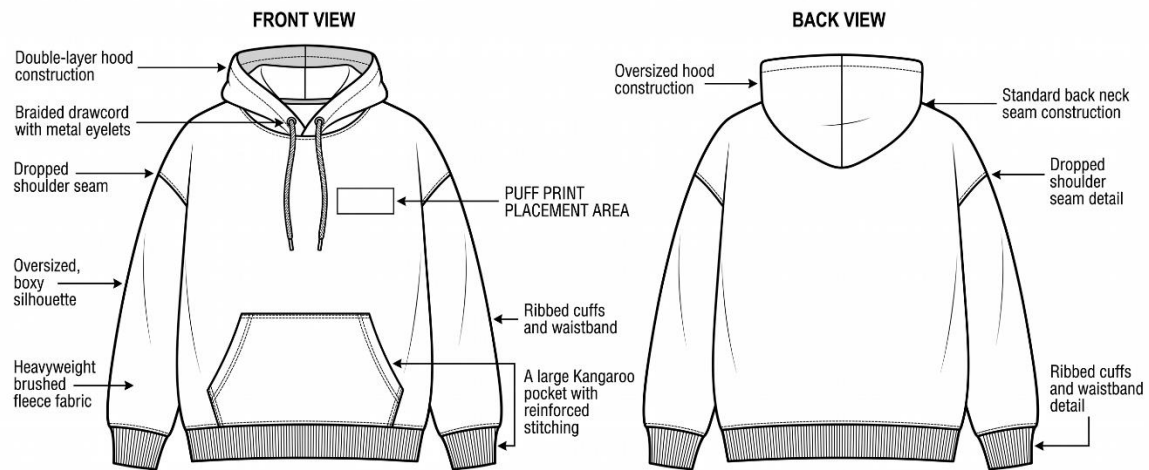


Figure 3 Technical flat sketch illustrating the construction details, oversized silhouette, puff print placement, rib structure, and heavyweight brushed fleece configuration used for comparative sourcing and FOB costing analysis.

4. SOURCING

The sourcing ecosystem for hoodie manufacturing in Turkey and Morocco is shaped by factors such as textile infrastructure, domestic fabric production capacity, import dependency, logistics efficiency, vertical integration, and proximity to export markets. Turkey operates as a highly integrated textile manufacturing economy with strong domestic production capabilities, whereas Morocco functions more as a garment assembly and fast-fashion nearshoring hub dependent on imported fabrics and trims. These sourcing structures significantly influence manufacturing lead times, pricing, production flexibility, and export competitiveness within the global hoodie manufacturing sector (Fibre2Fashion, 2024).

4.1 Country – Turkey

Turkey possesses one of the most advanced textile and knitwear manufacturing ecosystems in Europe and the Middle East. The country has strong domestic production capabilities across spinning, knitting, dyeing, finishing, garmenting, trims manufacturing, and packaging production. Turkish hoodie manufacturers largely rely on domestically produced fabrics due to the country's vertically integrated textile infrastructure and abundant cotton availability (International Trade Administration, 2023).

Approximately 70–75% of knit fabrics used in Turkish hoodie manufacturing are sourced domestically, while the remaining 25–30% are imported primarily for specialized synthetic performance fabrics, technical textiles, luxury trims, or low-cost sourcing requirements (Turkish Statistical Institute, 2024). Turkish textile mills produce a wide variety of hoodie fabrics including French Terry, brushed fleece, cotton-poly fleece, interlock knit, heavyweight fleece, and rib knit fabrics.

Major Turkish sourcing hubs include:

- Istanbul
- Bursa
- Kahramanmaraş
- Denizli
- Gaziantep
- Izmir

Kahramanmaraş is particularly important for fleece and knit fabric manufacturing, accounting for a significant share of Turkey’s circular knitting and fleece production ecosystem.

Table 4.1 Turkey Hoodie Fabric Sourcing Structure

Sourcing Type	Approximate Share (%)	Key Details
Domestic Fabric Production	70–75%	Strong knitwear & fleece ecosystem
Imported Fabric Usage	25–30%	Technical/specialized fabrics
Main Domestic Fabric Types	French Terry, Fleece, Rib Knit	Vertically integrated production
Main Import Countries	China, Italy, Portugal, South Korea	Technical textiles & specialty fabrics
Major Manufacturing Hubs	Istanbul, Bursa, Kahramanmaraş	Knitwear specialization

Table 4.2 Turkey Major Hoodie Fabric Types & Sourcing

Fabric Type	Domestic Production %	Import Dependency %	Major Manufacturing Region
French Terry	85%	15%	Kahramanmaraş
Brushed Fleece	80%	20%	Bursa
Heavyweight Fleece	70%	30%	Istanbul
Interlock Knit	75%	25%	Denizli
Rib Knit	90%	10%	Gaziantep

4.2 Country – Morocco

Morocco’s textile and apparel industry is highly export-oriented and primarily focused on garment assembly, fast-fashion production, and nearshoring operations for European markets. Unlike Turkey, Morocco has limited domestic fabric manufacturing capacity and therefore depends heavily on imported knit fabrics, trims, and accessories from Turkey, China, Spain, Portugal, and Italy (Oxford Business Group, 2023).

Approximately 60–65% of hoodie fabrics used in Morocco are imported, while domestic textile production contributes around 35–40% of total sourcing requirements. Moroccan garment manufacturers generally import:

- French Terry
- Brushed fleece
- Rib fabrics

- Technical knit fabrics
- Polyester fleece
- Performance fabrics

from Turkish and Portuguese suppliers due to their superior quality, lead-time efficiency, and established trade relations.

Major Moroccan sourcing and manufacturing hubs include:

- Casablanca
- Tangier
- Rabat
- Fez
- Kenitra

Tangier functions as a major logistics and export-processing hub connected closely with European supply chains through the Tangier Med Port infrastructure.

Table 4.3 Morocco Hoodie Fabric Sourcing Structure

Sourcing Type	Approximate Share (%)	Key Details
Domestic Fabric Production	35–40%	Limited knitwear production
Imported Fabric Usage	60–65%	Strong import dependency
Main Import Sources	Turkey, Portugal, China, Spain	Knit fabrics & trims
Major Manufacturing Hubs	Casablanca, Tangier, Rabat	Fast-fashion production
Main Competitive Advantage	Fast replenishment manufacturing	EU nearshoring

Table 4.4 Morocco Major Hoodie Fabric Types & Sourcing

Fabric Type	Domestic Production %	Import Dependency %	Main Source
French Terry	30%	70%	Turkey
Brushed Fleece	25%	75%	Turkey & Portugal
Heavyweight Fleece	20%	80%	Turkey
Interlock Knit	35%	65%	Portugal
Rib Knit	40%	60%	Turkey

5. LOCAL SUPPLIERS

5.1 Turkey Local Fabric Suppliers

Turkey has a highly developed supplier ecosystem consisting of vertically integrated textile groups, circular knitting mills, dyeing units, finishing companies, and export-oriented sourcing vendors.

Table 5.1 Turkey Hoodie Fabric Suppliers

Supplier Name	Location	Specialty	Website
Sanko Textile	Gaziantep	Knit Fabrics & Fleece	https://www.sankotekstil.com
Kipas Textiles	Kahramanmaraş	French Terry & Fleece	https://www.kipas.com.tr
Bossa Denim & Knit	Adana	Heavyweight Knitwear	https://www.bossa.com.tr
Yesim Textile	Bursa	Sustainable Knitwear	https://www.yesim.com
Iskur Textile	Kahramanmaraş	Cotton Fleece & Yarn	https://www.iskur.com.tr
Aksa Akrilik	Istanbul	Acrylic & Technical Fibers	https://www.aksa.com

5.2 Morocco Local Fabric Suppliers

Morocco's local supplier ecosystem focuses primarily on garment assembly, sourcing support, trims distribution, and limited knit fabric processing.

Table 5.2 Morocco Hoodie Fabric Suppliers

Supplier Name	Location	Specialty	Website
Inter Tricot	Casablanca	Knitwear Manufacturing	https://www.intertricot.com
Soft Group Morocco	Tangier	Sportswear & Knitwear	https://www.softgroup.ma
Richbond Group	Casablanca	Textile & Foam Products	https://www.richbondgroup.com
New Wash	Casablanca	Garment Washing & Finishing	https://www.newwash.ma
Modatex	Rabat	Textile Training & Sourcing	https://www.modatexcentre.com

5.3 Fabric Finishing

Fabric finishing processes significantly influence hoodie aesthetics, comfort, dimensional stability, durability, and product positioning. Premium hoodies often undergo multiple finishing treatments to improve softness, thermal insulation, and luxury appearance.

Table 5.3 Hoodie Fabric Finishing Processes

Finish Type	Approx. Cost (\$/kg)	Benefits	Top Suppliers (Turkey/Morocco)
Enzyme Wash	0.60–1.00	Soft hand feel, reduced fuzz	Yesim Textile / New Wash
Silicone Wash	0.80–1.20	Smooth luxurious feel	Kipas / Soft Group
Anti-Pilling Finish	0.50–0.90	Improved durability	Sanko Textile

Compacting	0.40–0.70	Shrinkage control	Iskur Textile
Brushing	0.50–1.00	Thermal insulation	Kipas Textile
Bio-Polishing	0.70–1.10	Surface smoothness	New Wash
Garment Dyeing	1.50–3.50	Vintage aesthetic	New Wash
Pigment Dyeing	2.00–4.00	Washed appearance	Turkish Wash Houses

5.4 Printing Suppliers

Table 5.4 Hoodie Printing & Embellishment Suppliers

Supplier Name	Location	Specialty	Website
Sun Textile Printing	Izmir, Turkey	Puff & Screen Printing	https://www.suntekstil.com.tr
New Wash	Casablanca, Morocco	Garment Dye & Wash	https://www.newwash.ma
Aster Textile	Istanbul, Turkey	Embroidery & Printing	https://www.astertextile.com
Moda In	Tangier, Morocco	Fast Fashion Printing	https://www.modain.ma
Yesim Textile	Bursa, Turkey	DTG & Sustainable Printing	https://www.yesim.com

5.5 Trims

Trims significantly influence hoodie functionality, aesthetics, branding, durability, and overall garment value addition.

Table 5.5 Common Hoodie Trims

Trim Type	Approx. Cost	Common Usage
Drawcords	\$0.20–0.60	Hood adjustment
Aglets	\$0.05–0.15	Cord finishing
Eyelets	\$0.03–0.10	Drawcord reinforcement
Rib Cuffs	\$0.50–1.20	Sleeve & waistband
Zippers	\$0.80–2.50	Zip-up hoodies
Silicone Badges	\$0.50–1.50	Branding
Woven Labels	\$0.08–0.25	Brand identity
Care Labels	\$0.03–0.10	Compliance
Polybags	\$0.10–0.30	Packaging

Drawcord Suppliers

Table 5.6 Drawcord Suppliers

Supplier	Address	MOQ	Description	Delivery Time
YKK Turkey	Istanbul	5,000 pcs	Premium cords & trims	2–3 weeks
MH Trims Morocco	Casablanca	3,000 pcs	Hoodie cords & aglets	3–4 weeks

Zipper Suppliers

Table 5.7 Zipper Suppliers

Supplier	Address	MOQ	Description	Delivery Time
YKK Turkey	Istanbul	5,000 pcs	Premium metal & coil zippers	2 weeks
SBS Morocco Distributor	Tangier	3,000 pcs	Fast-fashion zippers	3 weeks

Label Suppliers

Table 5.8 Label Suppliers

Supplier	Address	MOQ	Description	Delivery Time
Etiquette Textile	Bursa	2,000 pcs	Woven labels	1–2 weeks
Casablanca Label Works	Casablanca	2,500 pcs	Heat transfer labels	2 weeks

Packaging Suppliers

Table 5.9 Packaging Suppliers

Supplier	Address	MOQ	Description	Delivery Time
Packmore Turkey	Istanbul	5,000 pcs	Sustainable packaging	2 weeks
EcoPack Morocco	Rabat	3,000 pcs	Biodegradable polybags	2–3 weeks

6. COSTING ANALYSIS

6.1 Order Details & Production Assumptions

Product	Men's Oversized Heavyweight Hoodie	
Country	Turkey	Morocco
Buyer Category	European Fast Fashion	European Fast Fashion
Fabric	80/20 Cotton Polyester Brushed Fleece	80/20 Cotton Polyester Brushed Fleece
Order Quantity	1,500 Garments	3,000 Garments

Size	Ratio
S	1
M	2
L	2
XL	1

6.2 Garment Operation Breakdown & SAM Analysis

S.No	Operation	Machine Type	Stitch Class	SAM
1	Shoulder Join	Overlock	504	0.45
2	Hood Assembly	Overlock	504/514	0.6
3	Hood Attach	Flatlock	607	0.6
4	Sleeve Attach	Flatlock	607	0.85
5	Side Seam Join	Overlock	504	0.7
6	Pocket Hem Fold	SNLS	301	0.4
7	Pocket Attach	SNLS	301	0.6
8	Rib Join	Overlock	504	0.35
9	Waistband Attach	Coverstitch	602	0.55
10	Bottom Hem Finish	Coverstitch	605	0.35
11	Eyelet Attach	Eyelet Press	—	0.4
12	Label Attach	SNLS	301	0.25
13	QC & Trimming	Manual	—	0.5
14	Pressing	Steam Vacuum	—	1.2
15	Packing	Packing Table	—	1.5
Allowance				SAM
Bundle Handling				1.2
Machine Delay				1.1

Operator Fatigue	0.9
Inline QC Delay	0.75
Panel Matching	0.95
Puff Print Handling	0.8
Washing Rechecking	1
Total sam	16

6.3 CPM (Cost Per Minute) Calculation

Factory Labour Assumptions	Turkey	Morocco
Particulars	Value	Value
Total Sewing Operators	35	33
Working Days/Month	26	26
Working Hours/Day	8	8
Minutes/Day	480	480
Factory Efficiency	80%	78%

Total Available Minutes	Turkey	Morocco
	436800	411840
Total available min *factory efficiency	349440	321235.2

Total Labour Cost per month	Turkey	Morocco
Salary for a single labour	\$600	\$300
Total labour salary	\$21,000	\$9,900
Then helpers, supervisors, cutting QC finishing support	additional: support, staff,	\$27,000 \$13,500

CPM Calculation	Turkey	Morocco
Total Labour Cost per month/Total Available minutes	0.077266484	0.042025282
approx.	0.08	0.05
Base cm(sewing opertor)	1.28	0.8
addition of cutting support,trimming,checking,packing.	\$2.08	\$1.46

6.4 Direct Material Cost Analysis

TURKEY		
MOQ:1500		
Cutting Department	Cost/Garment	Total Cost
Fleece Fabric	\$8.63	\$12,945
Rib Fabric	\$1.79	\$2,685
Drawcord	\$0.35	\$525
Eyelets	\$0.04	\$60
Aglets	\$0.10	\$150
Sewing Thread	\$0.18	\$270
Labels	\$0.13	\$195
Packaging Materials	\$0.23	\$345
Total	\$11.45	\$17,175

MOROCCO		
MOQ:3000		
Particulars	Cost/Garment	Total Cost
imported Fleece Fabric	\$9.10	\$27,300
Rib Fabric	\$1.95	\$5,850
Drawcord	\$0.48	\$1,440
Eyelets	\$0.08	\$240
Aglets	\$0.12	\$360
Sewing Thread	\$0.18	\$540
Labels	\$0.16	\$480
Packaging Materials	\$0.28	\$840
Total	\$12.35	\$37,050

6.5 Direct Labour Cost Analysis

DIRECT LABOUR COST			
Turkey		Morocco	
Department	Total Cost	Department	Total Cost
Cutting Department	\$210	Cutting Department	\$300
Sewing Department	\$1,890	Sewing Department	\$2,760
Finishing & QC	\$540	Finishing & QC	\$720

Packing Department	\$480		Packing Department	\$600
Total Labour Cost	\$3,120		Total Labour Cost	\$4,380
Labour Cost/Garm ent	\$2.08		Labour Cost/Garm ent	\$1.46

DIRECT EXPENSES

Particulars	Cost/Garm ent	Total Cost
Puff Print	\$0.85	\$1,275
Silicone + Enzyme Wash	\$0.70	\$1,050
Fabric Testing	\$0.10	\$150
Total Direct Expense		\$2,475

Particulars	Cost/Garm ent	Total Cost
Puff Print	\$0.90	\$2,700
Silicone + Enzyme Wash	\$0.80	\$2,400
Fabric Testing	\$0.12	\$360
Total Direct Expense		\$5,460

6.6 Prime cost :

Turkey	
The total of all direct costs involved	\$22,770.00

Morocco	
The total of all direct costs involved	\$46,890.00

6.7 Factory Overhead

	Turkey	Morocco
Overhead	\$20,295	\$41,430
Overhead 15%	\$3,044	\$6,215

6.8 Indirect cost Analysis:

Indirect cost		
Particulars	Total Cost(TURKEY)	Total Cost(MOROCCO)
Bundle Tags	\$45	\$90
Barcode Stickers	\$30	\$60
Carton Markings	\$15	\$30
Carton Tape Allocation	\$23	\$45
Polybag Stickers	\$15	\$30
Assortment Sheets	\$30	\$60
Total Indirect Material Cost	\$158	\$315

6.9 Logistics & export cost :

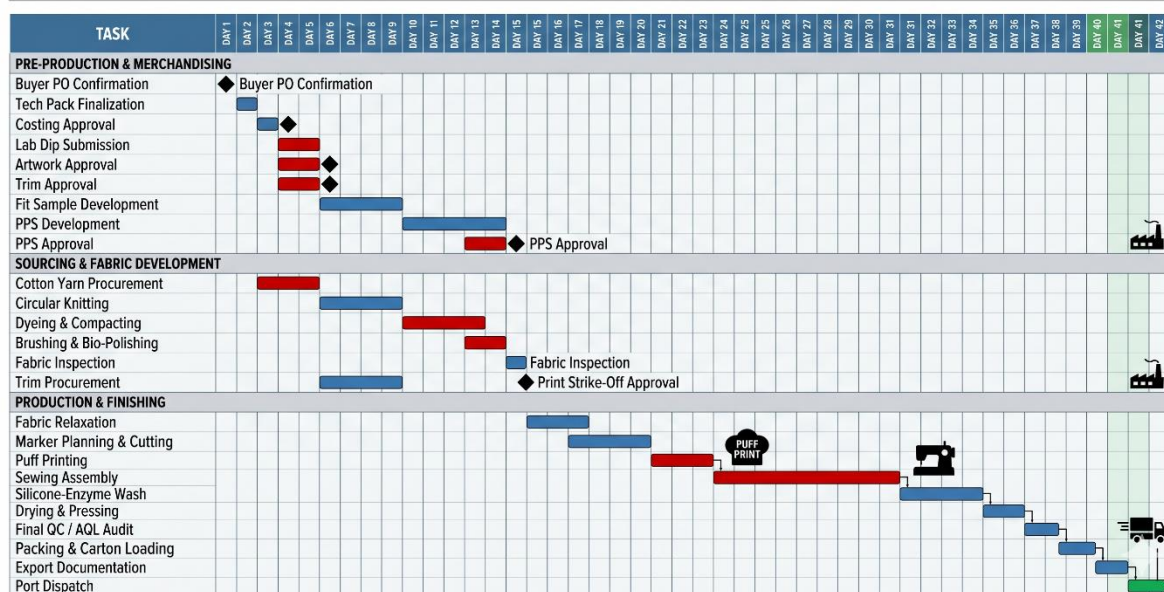
LOGISTICS & EXPORT COST		
Particulars	Total Cost(TURKEY)	Total Cost(MOROCCO)
Inland Transportation	\$450	\$720
Export Documentation	\$300	\$420
Customs Coordination	\$180	\$240
Port Handling & Loading	\$420	\$690
Container Handling Charges	\$210	\$390
Cargo Movement to Port	\$150	\$240
Total Logistics Cost	\$1,710	\$2,700

	TURKEY	MOROCCO
FOB cost	\$27,682.25	\$56,119.50
profit of 8%	\$2,768.23	\$4,489.56
final fob value	\$30,450.48	\$60,609.06
cost per garment	\$20.30	\$20.20

7. TIME AND ACTION CALENDAR (TNA)

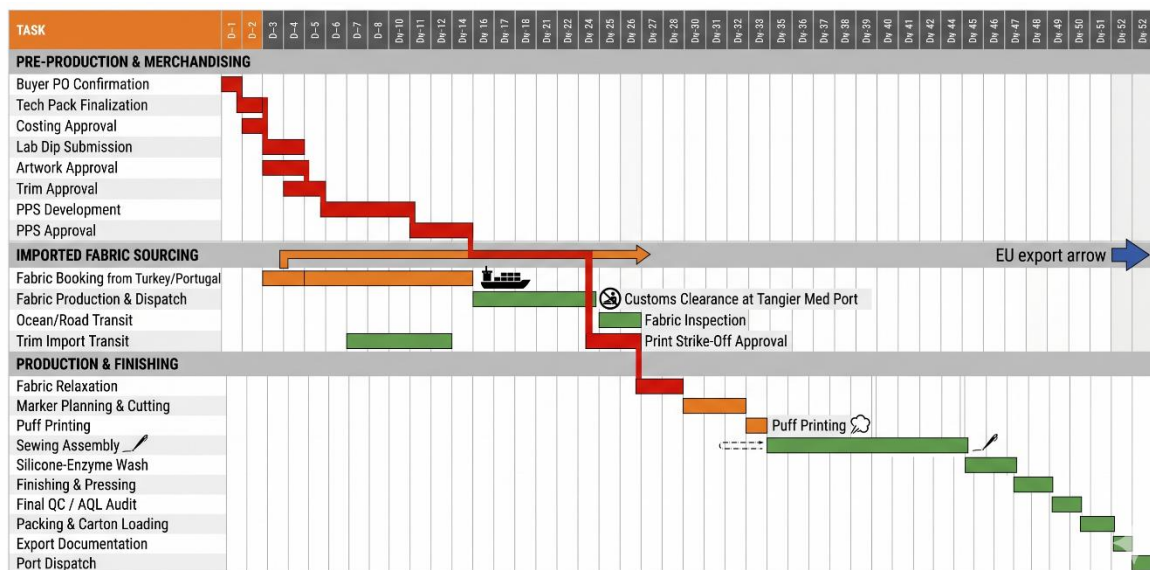
Figure 4TURKEY TNA CALENDAR

PRE-PRODUCTION & MERCHANDISING TNA —						
Activity	Responsible Department	Start Day	End Day	Duration	Critical Path	Operational Notes
Buyer PO Confirmation	Buyer / Merchandiser	Day 1	Day 1	1 Day	No	Order quantity and size ratio finalized
Tech Pack Finalization	Product Development	Day 1	Day 2	2 Days	Yes	Construction details locked
Costing Approval	Merchandising Team	Day 2	Day 3	1 Day	No	FOB confirmation
Lab Dip Submission	Fabric Mill	Day 3	Day 5	3 Days	Yes	Shade approval under D65 light
Artwork Approval	Buyer / Graphics Team	Day 4	Day 6	3 Days	Yes	Puff print artwork finalized
Trim Approval	Sourcing Dept	Day 4	Day 6	3 Days	No	Eyelets, drawcords, labels
Fit Sample Development	Sampling Room	Day 6	Day 9	4 Days	No	Oversized fit validation
PPS Development	Sample Room	Day 10	Day 13	4 Days	Yes	Bulk production reference sample
PPS Approval	Buyer	Day 14	Day 15	2 Days	Yes	Bulk production gate approval
SOURCING & FABRIC DEVELOPMENT						
Cotton Yarn Procurement	Spinning Mill	Day 3	Day 5	3 Days	No	Local cotton sourcing
Circular Knitting	Knitting Division	Day 6	Day 10	5 Days	Yes	360 GSM brushed fleece
Dyeing & Compacting	Dye House	Day 11	Day 14	4 Days	Yes	Silicone compatibility finishing
Brushing & Bio-Polishing	Finishing Dept	Day 13	Day 15	3 Days	Yes	Surface softening
Fabric Inspection (4-Point)	QA Department	Day 15	Day 16	1 Day	Yes	GSM, shade, defects
Trim Procurement	Accessories Dept	Day 6	Day 10	5 Days	No	Local Istanbul trim sourcing
Print Strike-Off Approval	Printing Dept	Day 14	Day 15	2 Days	Yes	Puff print sample approval
PRODUCTION & FINISHING						
Fabric Relaxation	Cutting Dept	Day 16	Day 17	2 Days	No	Prevent shrinkage distortion
Marker Planning & Cutting	CAD / Cutting Dept	Day 18	Day 20	3 Days	No	Oversized marker efficiency
Puff Printing	Printing Dept	Day 21	Day 23	3 Days	Yes	Heat-cured puff print
Sewing Assembly	Sewing Floor	Day 24	Day 31	8 Days	Yes	Flatlock + coverstitch operations
Silicone-Enzyme Wash	Washing Dept	Day 32	Day 34	3 Days	Yes	Soft hand-feel finishing
Drying & Pressing	Finishing Dept	Day 35	Day 36	2 Days	No	Shape stabilization
Final QC / AQL Audit	QA Team	Day 37	Day 38	2 Days	Yes	Export quality inspection
Packing & Carton Loading	Packing Dept	Day 39	Day 40	2 Days	No	Polybag and export carton packing
Export Documentation	Logistics Team	Day 40	Day 41	2 Days	No	Invoice, COO, packing list
Port Dispatch	Logistics Team	Day 41	Day 42	1 Day	No	Shipment to EU



PRE-PRODUCTION & MERCHANDISING TNA — MOROCCO						
Activity	Responsible Department	Start Day	End Day	Duration	Critical Path	Operational Notes
Buyer PO Confirmation	Buyer / Merchandiser	Day 1	Day 1	1 Day	No	Export order confirmation
Tech Pack Finalization	Product Development	Day 1	Day 2	2 Days	Yes	Hoodie construction locked
Costing Approval	Merchandising Team	Day 2	Day 3	1 Day	No	FOB agreement
Lab Dip Approval	Imported Fabric Supplier	Day 3	Day 6	4 Days	Yes	Shade approval
Artwork Approval	Buyer / Graphics Team	Day 4	Day 6	3 Days	Yes	Puff print approval
Trim Approval	Accessories Dept	Day 5	Day 7	3 Days	No	Imported eyelets and trims
PPS Development	Sample Room	Day 8	Day 12	5 Days	Yes	Buyer reference sample
PPS Approval	Buyer	Day 13	Day 15	3 Days	Yes	Bulk production approval
IMPORTED FABRIC SOURCING TNA — MOROCCO						
Fabric Booking (Turkey/Portugal)	Sourcing Team	Day 4	Day 6	3 Days	Yes	Import sourcing confirmation
Fabric Production & Dispatch	Supplier Mill	Day 7	Day 16	10 Days	Yes	Heavy fleece production
Ocean / Road Transit	Logistics Team	Day 17	Day 22	6 Days	Yes	Turkey/Portugal to Morocco
Customs Clearance	Import Logistics	Day 23	Day 24	2 Days	Yes	Tangier Med customs
Fabric Inspection	QA Department	Day 25	Day 26	2 Days	Yes	4-point inspection
Trim Import Transit	Accessories Team	Day 10	Day 15	6 Days	No	EU trim imports
Print Strike-Off Approval	Printing Dept	Day 25	Day 26	2 Days	Yes	Puff print approval
PRODUCTION & FINISHING TNA — MOROCCO						
Fabric Relaxation	Cutting Dept	Day 27	Day 28	2 Days	No	Relaxation before cutting
Marker Planning & Cutting	CAD / Cutting Dept	Day 29	Day 31	3 Days	No	Oversized hoodie marker
Puff Printing	Printing Dept	Day 32	Day 34	3 Days	Yes	Front chest puff print
Sewing Assembly	Sewing Floor	Day 35	Day 42	8 Days	Yes	CMT-heavy production
Silicone-Enzyme Wash	Washing Dept	Day 43	Day 45	3 Days	Yes	Soft-touch premium finish
Finishing & Pressing	Finishing Dept	Day 46	Day 47	2 Days	No	Final pressing
Final QC / AQL Audit	QA Team	Day 48	Day 49	2 Days	Yes	Buyer inspection
Packing & Carton Loading	Packing Dept	Day 50	Day 51	2 Days	No	Export packing
Export Documentation	Logistics Team	Day 51	Day 52	2 Days	No	Export documentation
Port Dispatch	Logistics Team	Day 52	Day 52	1 Day	No	EU shipment dispatch

Figure 5 MOROCCO TNA CALENDAR



Parameter	Turkey	Morocco
Manufacturing Structure	Vertically Integrated	Import-Dependent Nearshore
Total Lead Time	38–42 Days	45–52 Days
Fabric Availability	Local	Imported
Fabric Transit Dependency	Low	High
Production Flexibility	High	Moderate
EU Export Speed	Fast	Very Fast
Risk of Delay	Lower	Higher
Best Manufacturing Model	Premium Streetwear	Fast Fashion Replenishment

7.1 Key Industrial Observations

- Turkey benefits from domestic yarn spinning, knitting, dyeing, and finishing capabilities, resulting in shorter sourcing lead times and improved flexibility for premium hoodie manufacturing.
- Morocco relies heavily on imported heavyweight fleece fabrics from Turkey, Portugal, and Spain, increasing total sourcing lead time but compensating through lower labor costs and rapid EU logistics access.
- Puff print approval and silicone-enzyme washing remain critical path operations in both sourcing ecosystems due to their impact on garment quality and final appearance.

8. FUTURE SCOPE, CHALLENGES & STRATEGIC INDUSTRY OUTLOOK OF THE GARMENT INDUSTRY IN TURKEY AND MOROCCO

8.1 Introduction

The global apparel industry is undergoing a major transformation due to changing consumer behaviour, sustainability regulations, technological advancements, geopolitical sourcing shifts, and the rapid expansion of digital commerce. Countries such as Turkey and Morocco have emerged as strategically important sourcing destinations for European and global fashion

brands because of their geographic proximity, flexible manufacturing capabilities, and export-oriented production systems.

Both countries play important roles within the global apparel supply chain; however, their competitive positioning differs significantly. Turkey is recognized for vertically integrated textile manufacturing, premium knitwear production, and sustainable processing infrastructure, while Morocco has become a strong nearshoring hub specializing in fast-fashion replenishment manufacturing and agile export logistics.

The future growth of both countries will depend on:

- technological modernization,
- sustainable manufacturing adoption,
- labour force development,
- digital supply chain integration,
- and global sourcing competitiveness.

8.2 Increasing Domestic and Global Market Demand

Global demand for:

- athleisure,
- oversized streetwear,
- casualwear,
- and comfort-oriented fashion products

has increased significantly over the past decade. The rise of hybrid work culture, social-media-driven fashion consumption, and Gen Z streetwear trends has accelerated the global demand for hoodies, sweatshirts, and knit casualwear products.

Turkey has positioned itself as a premium apparel sourcing destination for:

- European luxury casualwear,
- premium knitwear,
- sustainable streetwear,
- and high-quality fleece garments.

The country's advanced textile infrastructure enables it to produce:

- heavyweight brushed fleece,
- premium garment dyeing,
- advanced embellishments,
- and sustainable knitwear collections.

Morocco, on the other hand, has emerged as a highly competitive nearshore sourcing destination for European fast-fashion brands such as Zara, Mango, and Bershka. The country benefits from:

- short lead times,

- rapid replenishment manufacturing,
- low-volume flexible production,
- and strong logistics connectivity with Southern Europe.

The increasing demand for:

- fast replenishment production,
- low MOQ sourcing,
- and short delivery cycles

will continue strengthening Morocco's position within the European apparel supply chain.

8.3 Government Support and Industrial Incentives

Government policies play a major role in the development of apparel manufacturing industries.

Turkey

The Turkish government has consistently supported the textile and apparel sector through:

- export incentives,
- investment subsidies,
- sustainability funding,
- industrial modernization programs,
- and machinery upgrading schemes.

Organizations such as:

- İHKİB (Istanbul Apparel Exporters' Association),
- the Turkish Ministry of Trade,
- and textile industrial clusters

actively promote export competitiveness and sustainable production development.

Turkey also benefits from:

- strong industrial infrastructure,
- domestic raw material production,
- and established textile manufacturing ecosystems in Bursa, Istanbul, Denizli, Gaziantep, and Kahramanmaraş.

Morocco

The Moroccan government has aggressively promoted export-oriented apparel manufacturing through:

- free trade zones,
- foreign direct investment incentives,
- logistics infrastructure development,
- and industrial acceleration plans.

The AMITH “Dayem” strategic roadmap aims to:

- expand textile exports,
- improve local value addition,
- increase sustainable production,
- and strengthen Morocco’s role as Europe’s nearshore sourcing hub.

Industrial zones such as:

- Tangier Free Zone,
- Casablanca industrial clusters,
- and Tanger Med logistics infrastructure

have significantly improved Morocco’s global sourcing competitiveness.

8.4 Sustainable and Eco-Friendly Fashion

Sustainability has become one of the most important competitive factors within the global apparel industry. International buyers increasingly require:

- traceable sourcing,
- environmentally responsible dyeing,
- recycled materials,
- water-efficient production,
- and compliance with global environmental standards.

Turkey has developed a strong sustainability ecosystem through:

- GOTS-certified organic cotton production,
- OEKO-TEX-certified textile mills,
- ZDHC-compliant wet processing,
- recycled polyester integration,
- and renewable-energy textile plants.

Many Turkish manufacturers now focus on:

- low-water dyeing,
- circular production systems,
- and biodegradable packaging solutions.

Morocco is also investing heavily in green manufacturing transformation. Due to increasing EU environmental regulations, Moroccan apparel manufacturers are adopting:

- energy-efficient machinery,
- sustainable washing technologies,
- water recycling systems,
- and eco-friendly packaging materials.

The growing global demand for sustainable apparel sourcing will continue creating competitive opportunities for both countries.

8.5 Adoption of Digital Technologies and Industry 5.0

The apparel industry is rapidly shifting toward:

- automation,
- smart manufacturing,
- AI-based production planning,
- digital merchandising,
- and Industry 5.0 systems.

Turkey is technologically more advanced due to its:

- integrated textile infrastructure,
- automated knitting systems,
- CAD/CAM integration,
- robotic cutting systems,
- and advanced printing technologies.

Large Turkish factories increasingly use:

- ERP software,
- digital sampling,
- 3D garment simulation,
- and automated warehouse systems.

Morocco is also rapidly modernizing its manufacturing systems, particularly within:

- fast-fashion production,
- digital order tracking,
- and agile manufacturing systems.

As buyers increasingly demand:

- transparency,
- shorter lead times,
- and real-time production visibility,

digital transformation will become a critical competitive advantage.

8.6 Rise of Direct-to-Consumer (D2C) Brands and E-Commerce

The growth of:

- e-commerce,
- influencer-driven brands,
- and direct-to-consumer (D2C) streetwear businesses

has significantly transformed global sourcing dynamics.

Modern fashion brands increasingly demand:

- low MOQ production,
- rapid style changes,
- flexible sourcing,
- and shorter replenishment cycles.

Turkey benefits strongly from the D2C growth model because its vertically integrated supply chain enables:

- premium sampling,
- low MOQ development,
- fast fabric customization,
- and complex garment finishing.

Morocco benefits from:

- rapid production turnaround,
- quick EU delivery,
- and flexible sewing operations.

This trend is expected to increase demand for:

- agile sourcing ecosystems,
- small-batch manufacturing,
- and nearshore production hubs.

8.7 Growth Through Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)

Trade agreements significantly influence apparel sourcing competitiveness.

Turkey

Turkey benefits from:

- the EU-Turkey Customs Union,
- simplified export systems,
- and preferential access to European markets.

These agreements reduce:

- customs barriers,
- shipment delays,
- and export duties.

Turkey's strategic geographic location between Europe and Asia also improves:

- sourcing flexibility,
- multimodal logistics access,
- and regional trade integration.

Morocco

Morocco benefits from:

- EU Association Agreements,
- Pan-Euro-Mediterranean (PEM) rules,
- and duty-free export access to Europe.

These agreements allow Moroccan factories to:

- import fabrics from PEM member countries,
- assemble garments locally,
- and export finished apparel to the EU with preferential tariff treatment.

This significantly strengthens Morocco's position within fast-fashion sourcing networks.

8.8 Full-Package and Value-Added Manufacturing Growth

The apparel industry is shifting from traditional:

CMT (Cut-Make-Trim)

towards:

Full-Package Manufacturing (FOB)

where suppliers manage:

- sourcing,
- product development,
- printing,
- washing,
- packaging,
- logistics,
- and export coordination.

Turkey already operates strongly as a:

vertically integrated FOB manufacturing hub

with advanced capabilities in:

- knitting,
- dyeing,
- garment finishing,
- and sustainable processing.

Morocco is increasingly transitioning from:

labour-intensive assembly
towards:

value-added manufacturing systems.

This transition will improve:

- profitability,
- sourcing independence,
- and export competitiveness.

8.9 Green Production and Sustainability as Competitive Advantage

Environmental regulations within Europe are becoming stricter, especially regarding:

- carbon emissions,
- wastewater treatment,
- traceability,
- and chemical compliance.

Turkey has developed strong competitive advantages through:

- sustainable knitwear manufacturing,
- organic cotton sourcing,
- advanced wastewater treatment,
- and certified eco-processing systems.

Morocco is increasingly promoting:

- renewable-energy apparel factories,
- sustainable industrial zones,
- and low-carbon logistics systems.

As sustainability becomes a core sourcing requirement, green manufacturing capabilities will increasingly determine:

- buyer preference,
- sourcing allocation,
- and long-term export competitiveness.

8.10 Labour Force Analysis

Labour availability and workforce skill levels significantly affect apparel manufacturing competitiveness.

Turkey

Turkey possesses:

- a highly experienced textile workforce,
- advanced technical expertise,
- strong knitwear specialization,
- and sophisticated garment finishing capabilities.

Turkish workers are particularly skilled in:

- premium knitwear assembly,
- garment dyeing,
- advanced embellishment techniques,
- and sustainable processing systems.

However, Turkey faces challenges related to:

- rising labour costs,
- inflation,
- and increasing operational expenses.

Morocco

Morocco benefits from:

- lower labour costs,
- abundant industrial labour availability,
- and strong fast-fashion sewing capabilities.

The Moroccan workforce is highly competitive in:

- labour-intensive assembly,
- flexible production systems,
- and fast replenishment manufacturing.

However, Morocco still faces limitations in:

- technical textile expertise,
- advanced fabric manufacturing,
- and integrated textile engineering capabilities.

Investment in:

- skill development,
- technical education,
- and digital manufacturing training

will be critical for future growth.

8.11 SWOT Analysis — Turkey

Strengths	Weaknesses
Vertically integrated textile ecosystem	Higher labour cost

Advanced sustainable manufacturing	Inflation volatility
Premium knitwear specialization	Currency fluctuations
Strong EU market connectivity	Higher operating expenses
Advanced printing & finishing	Competitive pricing pressure
Opportunities	Threats
Growth in sustainable streetwear	Competition from Asia
Expansion of premium exports	Rising energy costs
Organic cotton demand	Global economic instability
Technical textile development	Margin pressure from buyers

8.12 SWOT Analysis — Morocco

Strengths	Weaknesses
Competitive labour costs	Dependence on imported fabrics
Strong EU nearshore logistics	Limited vertical integration
Fast-fashion flexibility	Lower technical textile capability
Short lead times	Dependency on external sourcing
Opportunities	Threats
Growth in fast-fashion sourcing	Competition from Asian countries
Expansion of D2C production	Supply chain disruptions
Sustainable manufacturing growth	Import dependency risk
Nearshore sourcing expansion	Energy & logistics cost increases

8.13 PESTEL Analysis

Turkey

Factor	Analysis
Political	Strong EU trade relationships and export-oriented policies
Economic	Inflation and currency volatility impact production costs
Social	Highly experienced textile workforce
Technological	Advanced manufacturing and automation systems
Environmental	Strong sustainability investments and certifications
Legal	Established export compliance and labour regulations

Morocco

Factor	Analysis
Political	Stable industrial development policies
Economic	Competitive labour-driven export economy
Social	Growing industrial workforce availability
Technological	Rapidly developing manufacturing systems
Environmental	Increasing green production initiatives

8.14 Major Challenges Facing the Apparel Industry

Despite strong growth potential, both countries face several strategic challenges.

Turkey Challenges

- Rising inflation and labour costs
- Currency instability
- Energy price fluctuations
- Global sourcing competition from Asia
- Increasing sustainability compliance costs

Morocco Challenges

- Heavy dependence on imported fabrics
- Limited local textile integration
- Technical skill development gaps
- Vulnerability to global shipping disruptions
- Dependence on European fast-fashion demand

8.15 Strategic Future Outlook

Turkey is expected to maintain its position as:

- a premium knitwear sourcing destination,
- a sustainable textile manufacturing leader,
- and a vertically integrated apparel export hub.

Morocco is expected to continue growing as:

- Europe's nearshore fast-fashion manufacturing hub,
- a rapid replenishment sourcing destination,
- and a competitive low-cost apparel exporter.

The increasing global demand for:

- oversized streetwear,
- sustainable sourcing,
- digital manufacturing,
- and agile supply chains

will continue strengthening the strategic importance of both countries within the global apparel sourcing ecosystem.

9. CONCLUSION

The global apparel industry is undergoing a major transformation driven by:

- changing consumer lifestyles,
- sustainability requirements,
- fast-fashion expansion,
- digital manufacturing technologies,
- and evolving global sourcing strategies.

Within this dynamic environment, Turkey and Morocco have emerged as two strategically important apparel sourcing destinations for European and global fashion markets. Both countries possess distinct competitive advantages that make them highly relevant within modern apparel supply chains, particularly for the manufacturing of oversized heavyweight streetwear hoodies.

This study comprehensively analysed:

- the global garment industry,
- the commercial significance of oversized pullover heavyweight hoodies,
- fabric characteristics,
- sourcing ecosystems,
- trim and accessory procurement,
- manufacturing infrastructure,
- printing and washing systems,
- labour force structures,
- costing methodologies,
- supplier ecosystems,
- and strategic sourcing advantages of Turkey and Morocco.

The selected product category:

Men's Oversized Pullover Heavyweight Hoodie

was identified as one of the most commercially viable and globally demanded streetwear products due to:

- strong Gen Z market demand,
- increasing athleisure adoption,
- premium casualwear positioning,
- and high export relevance within European fashion sourcing systems.

The study demonstrated that:

Turkey possesses a strong competitive advantage in vertically integrated textile manufacturing.

Turkey benefits from:

- domestic cotton and yarn production,
- advanced circular knitting infrastructure,
- premium dyeing and finishing capabilities,
- sustainable textile ecosystems,

- advanced printing technologies,
- and highly developed trim manufacturing clusters.

These strengths allow Turkey to produce:

- premium heavyweight fleece garments,
- sustainable knitwear products,
- low MOQ premium streetwear collections,
- and value-added apparel manufacturing programs.

Turkey's vertically integrated ecosystem significantly reduces:

- sourcing dependency,
- lead-time variability,
- and production coordination complexity.

The study also revealed that:

Morocco has established itself as a powerful nearshore fast-fashion manufacturing hub.

Morocco's primary strengths include:

- competitive labour costs,
- flexible production systems,
- short lead times,
- rapid replenishment capabilities,
- and strong logistics connectivity with Europe through Tanger Med Port.

Although Morocco remains dependent on imported fleece fabrics and trims from:

- Turkey,
- Spain,
- Portugal,
- and other sourcing partners,

the country remains highly competitive due to:

- lower CMT costs,
- agile manufacturing systems,
- and fast delivery capabilities.

The comparative FOB costing analysis revealed that:

- Turkey achieved an FOB cost of approximately **\$21.39 per garment**,
- while Morocco achieved an FOB cost of approximately **\$20.50 per garment**.

The analysis showed that:

- Turkey's higher labour and operational costs are offset by strong vertical integration and premium manufacturing capabilities,
- whereas Morocco's lower labour costs compensate for its imported raw material dependency.

The study further demonstrated that:

- Turkey is more suitable for premium streetwear sourcing,
- sustainable knitwear manufacturing,
- heavyweight fleece production,
- and advanced value-added garment processing.

In contrast:

- Morocco is more suitable for fast-fashion replenishment sourcing,
- low-cost labour-intensive production,
- and rapid EU-focused apparel distribution systems.

The research additionally highlighted the increasing importance of:

- sustainability,
- Industry 5.0 technologies,
- digital sourcing systems,
- green manufacturing,
- and flexible supply chain integration.

Both Turkey and Morocco are actively adapting to these industry shifts through:

- sustainability investments,
- modernization initiatives,
- digital transformation,
- and export-oriented industrial strategies.

The Time and Action (TNA) analysis further demonstrated how sourcing structure directly affects:

- lead times,
- production planning,
- logistics coordination,
- and critical path management.

Turkey's domestic sourcing ecosystem provided:

- stronger production control,
- lower sourcing risk,
- and improved manufacturing coordination.

Meanwhile, Morocco's nearshore logistics infrastructure provided:

- exceptionally fast European delivery systems,
- replenishment flexibility,
- and agile export responsiveness.

In conclusion, this study establishes that both Turkey and Morocco occupy highly strategic positions within the global apparel sourcing industry. Their competitive strengths differ significantly, but both countries are expected to continue growing due to:

- increasing global demand for oversized streetwear,
- expansion of sustainable apparel sourcing,

- rise of direct-to-consumer fashion brands,
- and the growing importance of agile supply chain systems.

From a strategic sourcing perspective:

- Turkey is recommended for premium, sustainable, and value-added hoodie manufacturing,
- while Morocco is recommended for fast-fashion, cost-sensitive, and rapid replenishment apparel programs.

Therefore, the selection between Turkey and Morocco ultimately depends on:

- buyer sourcing strategy,
- target consumer positioning,
- product complexity,
- sustainability requirements,
- lead-time expectations,
- and cost optimization objectives.

The findings of this report demonstrate how global apparel sourcing decisions are increasingly shaped by:

- supply chain integration,
- technological advancement,
- sustainability compliance,
- and strategic manufacturing specialization,

making both Turkey and Morocco highly significant contributors to the future of global apparel manufacturing and export trade.

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